

Components of Cognitive Conceptualization.

In CBT [cognitive behavioral therapy] Cognitive Conceptualization is considered as a central process. CBT comes around 1960s - 70s, mainly established to treat depression. They think that irrational thoughts are one of the main reason for maladaptive behaviors or psychological problems. It is the first principle of cognitive behavioral therapy. It includes - key cognitions of an individual. Core beliefs - automatic negative thoughts, ~~and~~ intermediate beliefs & behavioral strategies. It is evolving throughout the therapy. It is considered as the structured understanding of how an individual's thoughts, emotions, behaviours - and experiences are interconnected and contribute to their psychological difficulties. Consist of different components & those working together to explain a person's mental functioning. First component is early experience which includes childhood upbringing, relationships & life events which shape how a person interprets their world. These early experience lead to the development of core beliefs, which are deep, rigid inclusions, I am worthless.

next level is intermediate beliefs which include attitudes, rules and assumptions that guide behavior. Such as "If I trust others, I will get hurt. When a person encounters a situation or trigger, these beliefs become activated and give rise to automatic thoughts which can be negative. Those can then influence emotional responses, such as anxiety, sadness or anger and lead to behavioral response. They may also experience symptoms like sweating, & muscle tension for example. A student who has anxiety about their upcoming exams. Their early experience like curriculum from parents may create a core belief that 'I am not capable'. This may further develop into an intermediate belief like 'If I fail, I am worthless. When faced with a student may develop automatic thoughts such as 'I will fail this test. These can trigger emotional response, behavioral and physiological symptoms. So Cognitive conceptualization provides a comprehensive framework for understanding how beliefs influence thoughts, emotions & behavior which could help therapist to plan effective interventions for change.